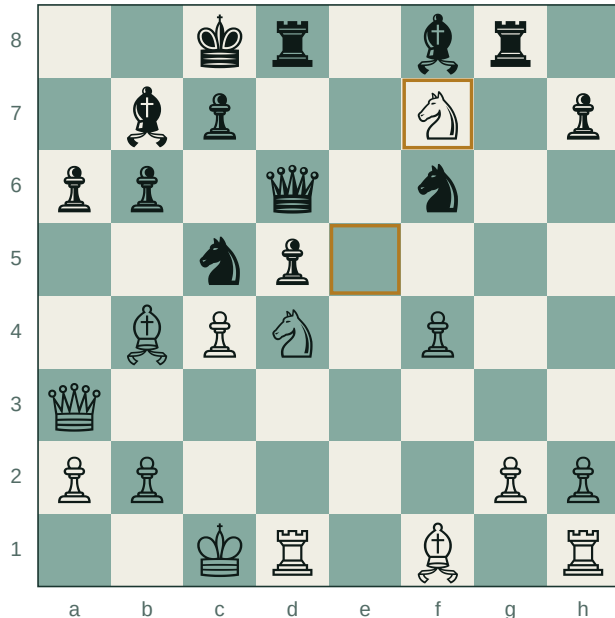


Interference tactics: Black, move 21

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Nxf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Qxf4+ 22. Bd2 Qxd4

21...Qxf4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on c1, knight on d4 and bishop on f1. Recorded reply: **22.Bd2**.

22...Qxd4 The queen captures the knight on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 33 / Black 36 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: knight on f7 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.